



A SNAPSHOT

- The Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship runs a number of schemes for training, re-skilling and upskilling
- The central scheme, Skill India Mission, includes PM Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY), the Jan Sikshashan Sansthan and the National Apprenticeship Promotion Scheme
- Other schemes include PM Vishwakarma Yojana, Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Grameen Kaushalya Yojana and Rural Self Employment and Training Institutes
- Industrial Training Institutes provide long-term training through the Craftsmen Training Scheme

EXPANDING FOCUS

- PM Modi recently launched the centrally sponsored scheme PM-SETU for upgrading 1,000 ITIs with an outlay of ₹60,000 crore
- New National Skill Development Policy 2025 in the works with a target to skill 50% of the population
- Stipends for apprenticeship have been increased in the range of ₹6,800–12,300, from the earlier ₹5,000–9,000
- New training courses like Green Skills and Electric Vehicles training programme launched, PMKVY4.0 has courses on AI, IoT
- Centre to introduce skill-based learning in Class 11 and 12 based on NEP 2020 recommendations

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tion. The report on the Demand for Grants (2025-26) highlighted shortfalls in achievement of targets under various skilling schemes as well as low placements.

For instance, in FY25, 1.9 million candidates were trained under the PMKVY by March 3, 2025, as against a target of 4.5 million. Under the National Apprenticeship Promotion Scheme, around 900,000 candidates were engaged till February 28 in FY25, as against a target of 1.2 million. In fact, between FY23 and FY25, training under the PMKVY was given to only 2.8 million, or 19.53% of the targeted 14.4 million, people.

Low placements have also been an issue under the PMKVY and while the government has delinked placements under the PMKVY 4.0, the committee highlighted that “placement statistics are the real barometer for

measuring the success of the scheme”. The placement rate for short-term training certified candidates till PMKVY 3.0 was a mere 42.8%. Officials say gathering placement data is not always easy. For instance, at ITIs, students often do not revert on the jobs that they have got. Further, several opt for self-employment, which is often not captured in the data.

But Krishna has a slightly different take. “One must be clear that Skill India Mission’s aim is to impart market-relevant skills to youths, but it doesn’t play a direct role in creation of jobs, which is the collective responsibility of several ministries.”

That is not all. Experts and stakeholders highlight some other problems dogging this mammoth initiative. A big concern has been low pay. To partially ad-